

Summary

Subject: Inglés Profesional (Grado Superior)

Unit: 6. Work smarter

1. Quantifiers

Quantifiers indicate the quantity of something without specifying an exact number. They are used with countable (many, a few, few) and uncountable nouns (much, a little, little), although some of them can be used with both types (any, some, a lot of, lots of).

For countable nouns	For uncountable nouns	For both
Many	Much	Some
A few	A little	Any
Few	Little	A lot of / Lots of

2. Modal verbs

They are auxiliary verbs that express ability, possibility, necessity, permission, obligation, or advice. They do not change with the subject and are always followed by the base form of the main verb.

Category	Modal verbs	Usage	Example
Ability	can, could	Express ability or lack of it	She can play the piano.
Possibility	may, might, could	Express possibility or uncertainty	It might rain tomorrow.
Permission	can, may, could	Ask for or give permission	Can I go to the toilet, please?
Obligation	must, have to	Express necessity or obligation	I have to work tomorrow.
Prohibition	must not, can't	Express prohibition	You can't smoke in this area.
Advice	should, ought to	Give recommendations	You should visit a doctor.

3. Indefinite pronouns

They refer to nonspecific people, things, or places.

Category	Some-	Any-	No-	Every-
People	someone, somebody	anyone, anybody	no one, nobody	everyone, everybody
Things	something	anything	nothing	everything
Places	somewhere	anywhere	nowhere	everywhere

- **Some-**: Used mainly in affirmative sentences and in questions when offering or requesting something.
- **Any-**: Used in negative and interrogative sentences; in affirmative sentences meaning "it doesn't matter who/which/where."
- **No-**: Used only in affirmative sentences; cannot be followed by a negative verb.
- **Every-**: Used in affirmative, negative, and interrogative sentences to refer to an entire group.

4. The Saxon Genitive

It is a structure used to show possession by adding **'s** to the noun that owns something. It is mainly used with people, animals, and time expressions. For objects, the **of** structure is preferred (*"The speaker of the phone"* instead of *"The phone's speaker"*), although it is accepted for institutions, places, or media (*The company's reputation*). It follows some **spelling rules**:

- Singular nouns: Add **'s** (Mary's decision).
- Plural nouns not ending in -s: Add **'s** (The children's use).
- Plural nouns ending in -s: Add only **'** (My parents' car).
- Shared possession: Add **'s** only to the last name (Thomas and Walter's profiles).

5. The Passive Voice

- **Active sentences**: The subject performs the action. (*Tom uses many digital tools.*)
- **Passive sentences**: The subject receives action. The focus is on the action rather than who performs it. The agent (performer of the action) is introduced with *by*. (*Many digital tools are used by Tom.*)

To convert an active sentence into passive, follow this structure:

Subject + verb to be (in the same tense as the active voice) + past participle + agent

- The subject of the active sentence becomes the agent in the passive (preceded by *by*).
- The object of the active sentence becomes the subject in the passive.
- The verb to be is conjugated in the same tense as the active verb.
- The main verb is used in the past participle form.

6. Reported Speech

Reported speech is used to report what someone said without quoting their exact words, unlike **direct speech**, which uses **quotation marks** (""). When changing from direct to reported speech, verb tenses usually go a step back in the past, what is called **backshift** if the **reporting verb is in the past**.

Pronouns and possessives also change depending on the new context.

In questions, word order changes to a statement format, using **if/whether** for yes/no questions and keeping **wh- words** for others.

Commands use **told + (not) to + verb**, while requests use **asked + (not) to + verb**. Time and place expressions also adjust based on the new perspective.